Treasure Valley Permit Planning

Ada and Canyon County reference. Guidance checked October 1, 2026; confirm current requirements for the actual parcel.

Find the right authority

- Inside city limits: start with the city building department.
- Unincorporated property: start with the county building department.
- A mailing address does not establish jurisdiction. Confirm the parcel.
- Building, trade, septic, road, utility and HOA reviews can be separate.

Plan the application and inspections

- Ask for the application checklist, required plans and current review queue.
- Coordinate site, architectural, structural and energy documents as required.
- Confirm fees, outside approvals and who submits each application.
- Receive required permits before starting the work they cover.
- Schedule rough inspections before covering the work.
- Complete final approvals and required occupancy clearance.
- Review time depends on scope, completeness, corrections and the current queue.

Septic systems: use the correct health district

- Ada County: Central District Health (CDH).
- Canyon County: Southwest District Health (SWDH).
- Confirm septic feasibility and approvals before finalizing the site layout.

Official starting points

- City of Boise Building: cityofboise.org (Planning and Development Services)
- Ada County: adacounty.id.gov/developmentservices/
- Canyon County: canyoncounty.id.gov/building-department/
- Central District Health: cdh.idaho.gov (Septic, Subdivisions & Water)
- Southwest District Health: swdh.id.gov (Septic & Land Development)

Keep the project scope together

[ ] Parcel, proposed work and existing conditions identified

[ ] Permit responsibilities, fees and inspections included in the written scope

[ ] HOA approval checked separately where applicable

Guide and source links: https://boiseconstruction.co/resources/ada-canyon-permit-flow